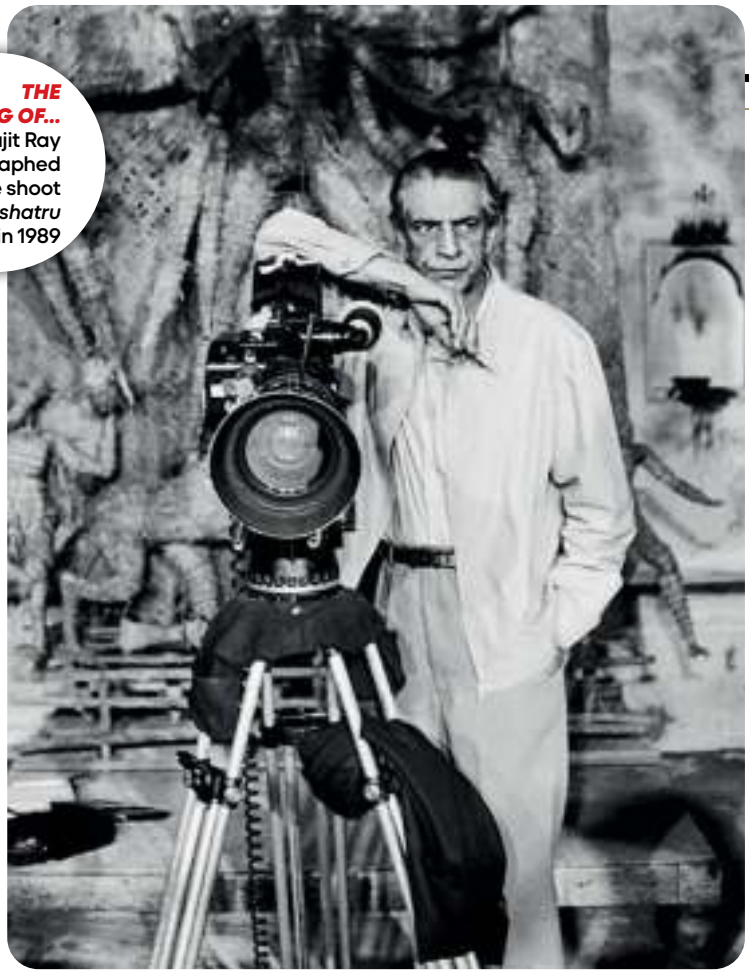


THE MAKING OF... Satyajit Ray photographed during the shoot of *Ghanashatru* in 1989

PHOTOGRAPHY ▼

WHAT THE CAMERA SAW

Nemai Ghosh's photographs of Satyajit Ray form a visual biography of the auteur

Light and Shadow: Satyajit Ray through Nemai Ghosh's Lens is now on view at Kolkata's Alipore Museum, presented by DAG in collaboration with the museum. The exhibition offers a rare and intimate look at the life and work of Satyajit Ray, one of India's greatest filmmakers, as captured over 25 years by photographer Nemai Ghosh. It remains on display until September 13.

Ghosh's extensive archive, now housed at DAG, documents Ray in both black-and-white and never-before-seen colour images. The photographs span scenes from film sets, moments of direction and Ray's personal world—at his drawing board, playing the piano or in quiet reflection at home.

Together, they form a visual biography of an auteur whose genius extended beyond directing to scriptwriting, set and costume design, music composition and cinematography. Deeply influenced by Italian neorealism and humanist storytelling, Ray brought subtlety and psychological depth to Indian cinema. Ghosh's lens captured this layered process, revealing a man profoundly immersed in his craft.



Nemai Ghosh's journey with Ray began in 1968 on the set of *Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne*, marking the start of a lifelong collaboration. Over two and a half decades, Ghosh developed an extraordinary sensitivity to Ray's creative rhythms, capturing candid moments of filmmaking and intimate glimpses into Ray's personal life that few others witnessed.

"Ray's dedication to his craft led Ghosh to follow him like a shadow and conditioned him to the exacting demands of the maestro," says Ashish Anand, CEO of DAG. "In Ray, Ghosh found not just a filmmaker but a mentor and friend."

The exhibition also highlights Ray's meticulous working style—his solitary walks through filming locations, his detailed sketches for costumes and sets, and his interactions with actors and technicians. Ghosh's photographs capture Ray's extraordinary range, from moments of creative solitude to collaborative filmmaking.

Light and Shadow offers visitors an unprecedented window into the creative world of Satyajit Ray—a master at work and at rest. ■

—Nikhil Sardana

NEMAI GHOSH'S (BELOW) JOURNEY WITH RAY **BEGAN IN 1968 ON THE SET OF *GOOPY GYNE BAGHA BYNE***, MARKING THE START OF A LIFELONG COLLABORATION